

Security+ 4.3 · Threat Intelligence

Master CyberSec — Official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) Comprehensive Study Guide · **Lesson 4.3 — Threat Intelligence (4:46)** · [Official YouTube Video ↗](#) · [Professor Messer Study Hub ↗](#)

Executive Lesson Summary: Threat intelligence aggregates data from OSINT (public sources), third-party feeds (CrowdStrike, RecordedFuture), community sharing (FS-ISAC), and dark web monitoring. The output is actionable IOCs (IPs, hashes, domains) integrated into SIEM/EDR for detection and blocking.

High-Yield Core Concepts Tested on Exam

- OSINT: publicly available information that reveals risk before an attack
- Threat feeds integrate with SIEM/EDR for automated blocking and detection
- IOCs: IP addresses, file hashes, domains used to identify threats
- Community sharing (e.g., FS-ISAC) enables sector-specific threat exchange
- Dark web monitoring detects leaked credentials and data

Exam Tips & Classic Scenarios

- 'publicly available information used for intelligence' = OSINT
- 'indicators of compromise shared with SIEM' = threat intelligence feed
- 'monitoring leaked credentials on underground forums' = dark web intelligence

Typical Exam Scenario: A company collects information from the dark web about leaked passwords, which is an example of threat intelligence gathering.

Beyond the Video: Official CompTIA Exam Concepts, Protocols & Traps (Lesson 4.3 — Threat Intelligence)

Why is this advanced coverage required for SY0-701? Video overviews provide foundational familiarity, but CompTIA tests practical engineering judgment and requires deep familiarity with the following protocols, acronyms, and operational nuances in this domain:

- **SIEM:** Security Information and Event Management: Centralized platform performing real-time ingestion, normalization, correlation, and alerting across multi-source security telemetry.
- **EDR:** Endpoint Detection and Response: Agent installed on endpoints providing behavioral telemetry, threat detection, investigation capabilities, and live remote isolation.

Classic CompTIA Traps & Question Framing:

- Avoid rote memorization: CompTIA exam prompts regularly adjust technical constraints requiring you to defend why one valid security control is the *MOST appropriate* or *FIRST step*.
- Scrutinize question qualifiers: 'without additional licensing costs' favors native OS tools; 'granular administrative command accounting' favors TACACS+ over RADIUS; 'non-repudiation' mandates asymmetric private key signing.

Practice Questions with In-Depth Solutions (10 Questions)

Detailed answer key with step-by-step technical rationale and comprehensive distractor breakdown provided below. Attempt answering independently first.

1. The NIST CSF framework organizes security into 5 functions. What are they?

- A)** Install, Update, Test, Audit, Archive
- B)** Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, Recover
- C)** Plan, Do, Check, Act, Review
- D)** Prevent, Punish, Predict, Prove, Publish

2. Corporate scenario (Threat Intelligence): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Implement the corresponding solution: OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack...
- B)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

3. Corporate scenario (Threat Intelligence): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'Threat feed + SIEM/EDR = blocking and detection'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: Threat feed + SIEM/EDR = blocking and detection...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

4. Corporate scenario (Threat Intelligence): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'publicly available information used for intelligence' = OSINT.' What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'publicly available information used for intelligence' = OSINT...

5. Corporate scenario (Threat Intelligence): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: "company collects dark web information about leaked password" = threat intelligence.'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'company collects dark web information about leaked password' = threat intelligence...

6. Corporate scenario (Threat Intelligence): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack.' What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

7. Corporate scenario (Threat Intelligence): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'Threat feed + SIEM/EDR = blocking and detection'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: Threat feed + SIEM/EDR = blocking and detection...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

8. Corporate scenario (Threat Intelligence): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'publicly available information used for intelligence'=OSINT. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'publicly available information used for intelligence'=OSINT...
- B)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials

9. Corporate scenario (Threat Intelligence): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'company collects dark web information about leaked passwords' = threat intelligence'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'company collects dark web information about leaked passwords' = threat intelligence.
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

10. Corporate scenario (Threat Intelligence): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack...



COMPREHENSIVE ANSWER KEY & DISTRACTOR BREAKDOWN

1) B — Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, Recover.

✓ **Why it's correct:** The NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) 2.0 organizes cybersecurity activities into five core functions: Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, and Recover. These functions represent the complete lifecycle of cyber risk management. 'Identify' involves understanding the organizational context, assets, risks, and vulnerabilities. 'Protect' covers implementing safeguards to ensure delivery of critical services. 'Detect' defines activities to identify the occurrence of cybersecurity events. 'Respond' comprises actions taken after an incident is detected. 'Recover' focuses on restoring capabilities or services that were impaired. This framework is widely adopted and required in the Security Architecture and Design domain of the CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) certification, specifically in objective 2.1, which deals with frameworks and guidelines.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Install, Update, Test, Audit, Archive:* These terms describe generic steps of an IT operational process, such as a software lifecycle or patch management, but they do not constitute the NIST CSF functions. 'Install' and 'Update' refer to system deployment and maintenance; 'Test' is a verification activity; 'Audit' is a compliance assessment; and 'Archive' is a data retention practice. None of these actions correspond to the high-level strategic functions defined by the NIST CSF, which are risk-oriented rather than tactical tasks.
- *Plan, Do, Check, Act, Review:* This is a variation of the PDCA cycle (Plan-Do-Check-Act), used in quality management and continuous improvement systems, such as ISO 9001. Although the NIST CSF can be integrated into continuous improvement processes, its five functions are not 'Plan, Do, Check, Act, Review'. PDCA is a generic management model, while CSF functions are specific to cybersecurity and have their own scope and definitions. The inclusion of 'Review' as a fifth step is a distortion, as the classic PDCA has four steps.
- *Prevent, Punish, Predict, Prove, Publish:* These terms are not part of any recognized cybersecurity framework. 'Prevent' is a goal, but not a CSF function; 'Punish' is a disciplinary or legal action, not a security function; 'Predict' is an aspirational goal, not an operational function; 'Prove' and 'Publish' are audit and communication actions, respectively, but they do not compose the NIST CSF structure. This alternative mixes concepts of justice, prediction, and disclosure, with no relation to the official functions of the framework.

2) A — Implement the corresponding solution: OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.3 (Threat Intelligence): OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

3) C — Implement the corresponding solution: Threat feed + SIEM/EDR = blocking and detection....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.3 (Threat Intelligence): Threat feed + SIEM/EDR = blocking and detection.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user behavior, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

4) D — Implement the corresponding solution: 'publicly available information used for intelligence' = OSINT....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.3 (Threat Intelligence): 'publicly available information used for intelligence' = OSINT. OSINT (Open-Source Intelligence) involves collecting and analyzing publicly available data from sources like social media, websites, and public records to inform security decisions.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user conduct and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

5) D — Implement the corresponding solution: 'company collects dark web information about leaked password' = threat intelligence....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.3 (Threat Intelligence): 'company collects dark web information about leaked password' = threat intelligence. Threat intelligence involves gathering and analyzing information about potential or existing threats to inform security decisions. Collecting data from the dark web about leaked credentials is a classic example of threat intelligence, as it helps organizations proactively defend against credential-based attacks.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* This directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* This destroys individual

accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who made critical changes or executed malicious commands.

6) C — Implement the corresponding solution: OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.3 (Threat Intelligence): OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack. Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT) is collected from publicly available sources (social media, forums, public records, DNS, etc.) and is used for proactive threat intelligence, attack surface discovery, and pre-attack risk identification.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to incident detection and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user conduct and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

7) C — Implement the corresponding solution: Threat feed + SIEM/EDR = blocking and detection....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.3 (Threat Intelligence): Threat feed + SIEM/EDR = blocking and detection. Integrating threat intelligence feeds with SIEM (Security Information and Event Management) and EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response) enables automated blocking of known malicious indicators and enhanced detection of threats.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* This directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and violates compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user behavior and do not block automated attacks, injections, or runtime malware.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* This destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

8) A — Implement the corresponding solution: 'publicly available information used for intelligence'=OSINT....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.3 (Threat Intelligence): 'publicly available information used for intelligence'=OSINT.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are

administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.

- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

9) B — Implement the corresponding solution: 'company collects dark web information about leaked passwords' = threat intelligence..

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.3 (Threat Intelligence): 'company collects dark web information about leaked passwords' = threat intelligence. Threat intelligence involves gathering and analyzing information about potential threats; the appropriate control is to implement the corresponding solution, such as monitoring dark web sources and integrating threat feeds.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who made critical changes or malicious commands.

10) D — Implement the corresponding solution: OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.3 (Threat Intelligence): OSINT: public information that reveals risk BEFORE the attack. OSINT (Open-Source Intelligence) involves collecting and analyzing publicly available information to identify potential threats and vulnerabilities before an attack occurs, enabling proactive defense.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user behavior, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.